

1.2 NEED AND IMPORTANCE OF TEACHING MATHEMATICS

1.2.1 Use of Mathematics in Daily Life

In this world of today nobody can live without mathematics for a single day. Mathematics is intimately involved in every moment of everyone's life. Right from human existence on this earth, it has been a faithful companion. When man first wanted to answer the question: (How many? How big? How long? etc.) he invented arithmetic. Algebra was devised to simplify arithmetical computations. For measurement and form, geometry was invented. To find the position of high mountains and stars trigonometry was invented and developed and so on in the case of numerous other branches of mathematics. The

knowledge of this subject was born out of felt needs of man. This knowledge is therefore indispensable. As the needs grow, the knowledge is bound to grow.

There is a definite need of mathematics in anybody's life-long planning and day-to-day planning. A human being is always after profitable and increasing returns. A mathematical approach is essential for any progress. Any approach devoid of mathematical considerations is likely to lead to decline. If anybody wants to make a success of his life, he must have recourse to mathematics.

Day-to-day evaluation in life or daily self-evaluation and over all life evaluation provide us assessment, judgment, guidance and direction for future. This evaluation will have to be mathematical in nature to a great extent.

Even the most ordinary citizen has got to calculate his wages and purchase of things from the bazaar. A person may be a mere housewife, farmer, labourer, shopkeeper, tailor, clerk, vendor, salesman, accountant, mason, driver, carpenter, or booking clerk, some knowledge of mathematics is absolutely necessary for him.

The entire atmosphere is surcharged with mathematics. The price rates, discounts, commissions, rebates, interests, taxes, shortages, production, distribution, inflation etc. are the issues with which everybody is intimately concerned. There is no escape from mathematical intricacies of life and livelihood.

All the illustrations and arguments in favour of practical value of mathematics can be utilized and repeated to justify the place of the subject in everyday life.